

(World Wide Developer Conference), it is one of the first operating systems in the series that focuses more on under the hood changes. The Snow Leopard boasts of improved performance and efficiency. Other optimisation features such as reduced memory footprint have been introduced as has improved compatibility with other non-Apple software.

A note of the hardware is required before diving into the whole Mac OS X experience. First, the Mac OS X was meant to run on an Apple computer. Apple shifted from Motorola to IBM's PowerPC architecture in the early



The New Mac Mini

80s. Come 2008, Snow Leopard will be accessible only on Intel compatible hardware. This exclusivity of Apple was notorious in the earliest versions of its systems. Simple connectors and adapter cables were unique. Nowadays, most standard hardware and peripherals have support.

Leopard can run on most Mac systems. The exact models can be found on Apple's support web site. You need a processor running at least 867 MHz or faster, with free memory of 9 GB on your hard disk and at least 512 MB RAM. Since most systems nowadays pack more punch than that, most of you will not have to worry about the basic requirements.

Let's look at the improvements Apple has packed into the OS X Snow Leopard. First, there's support for 64-bit systems. Sixty four-bit chips are very common nowadays and have lost a lot of their initial exclusivity. The reason why 64-bit is so popular is the amount of memory it can address. Most